COMPANY DEEP-DIVE

Global Head of Enterprise Sales at PayPal Believes AI-Enabled Platforms Like *Zip* and *Omnea* Are Transforming *Procurement* Processes

DATE PUBLISHED	INTERVIEW DATE	EXPERT PERSPECTIVE	ANALYST PERSPECTIVE	PRIMARY COMPANY
14 Oct 2026	16 Jul 2026	Consultant	Investor-Led (Buy-Side)	OMNEA, LTD.

SMART SUMMARY

Summary

The interview covers the expert's evaluation and implementation of AI-enabled ***procurement*** platforms, focusing on the selection and use of ***Zip*** and ***Omnea***, their integration with existing systems, and the criteria that drove decision-making.

EXPERT BACKGROUND

- Global Head of Enterprise Sales & Merchant Acquisition at a global payments fintech, leading strategy and digital transformation initiatives across finance, procurement, and supplier operations, with direct experience evaluating and implementing AI-enabled procurement platforms.

EXPERT SENTIMENT

- Believes AI-enabled procurement platforms are critical for modernizing procurement processes and improving employee experience.
- Sees Zip as the primary platform due to **its superior user experience and AI-driven intake, but values a best-of-breed** approach by also leveraging Omnea for supplier lifecycle management.
- Anticipates potential future expansion with Zip, but expects to continue using both platforms unless Zip significantly enhances its supplier onboarding and risk capabilities.

TAKEAWAYS

- Indirect ***procurement*** accounts for over 80% of spend, with ***Zip*** handling the majority of intake and orchestration, and ***Omnea*** focused on strategic ***procurement*** and supplier lifecycle management.
- The ***procurement*** stack includes ***Zip***, ***Omnea***, ERP systems, ServiceNow, Workday, Docusign, Snowflake, and Power BI, with ***Zip*** and ***Omnea*** as the primary ***procurement*** tools.
- ***Zip*** **was chosen for its superior colleague experience**, workflow orchestration, AI capabilities, and rapid integration, while ***Omnea*** excels in supplier intelligence and lifecycle management.
- AI in ***Zip*** acts as a ***procurement*** concierge for all employees, automating intake and orchestration, whereas Omnea's AI supports ***procurement*** professionals with supplier intelligence and contract management.
- **Implementation timelines were faster for** ***Zip*** (8-12 weeks to pilot, ~1 year to enterprise rollout) compared to Omnea (11-15 weeks to pilot, 1-1.5 years to rollout).

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Expert Bio

Global Head Of Enterprise Sales & Merchant Acquisition at PayPal Holdings Inc. / Former Vice President, Global Head Of Strategic Revenue Global Commercial Services at American Express Company (Apr 2022 - Aug 2024) The expert is a customer of both Zip and Omnea and explains that they led the executive evaluation and selection process during 2025–2026, comparing workflow automation, AI capabilities, ERP integrations, governance, and total cost of ownership. The expert can speak about the differences between these tools in depth. Global Head of Enterprise Sales and Merchant Acquisition at a PayPal. Reporting to the Chief Revenue Officer, the expert is responsible for leading the global enterprise sales strategy and overseeing merchant acquisition efforts to drive platform growth. This role includes direct Profit and Loss responsibility for the enterprise segment, where they authorize major commercial partitions, global pricing structures, and large-scale partnership integrations. Prior to PayPal, the expert was the Vice President, Global Head of Strategic Revenue -

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Global Commercial Services at American Express, leaving in August 2024. Reporting to the President of Global Commercial Services, the expert was responsible for leading a Global Centre of Excellence overseeing a $15 billion commercial Profit and Loss. They played a key role in developing net-new revenue by defining merchant acquiring, product, account management, sales, marketing, and partnership strategies, while managing a cross-functional team across data analytics and business development. The expert is a current partner of American Express IDC and has participated in Requests for Proposals (RFPs) for Zolve, TomoCredit, Karta, and Firstcard. As a final decision-maker for financial product partnerships as recently as 2024, they can speak to the key requirements for distributing credit cards to High-Net-Worth individuals who lack a Social Security Number or Taxpayer Identification Number, including alternative credit scoring models, KYC compliance for international profiles, and bespoke underwriting for non-traditional assets.

Interview Transcript

Client 00:00:00

Thank you for your time. Just to give you the context, we are exploring tools in the broader procurement space. The first question I wanted to ask is if you could just briefly outline your role and how you have experienced, just in 30 seconds, procurement tooling decisions in your company.

Expert 00:00:20

I lead a lot of the strategy and digital transformation for a global payments fintech. That touches finance, procurement, supplier operations, and everything, how it relates to our enterprise merchant partnerships. If you think about it, we are right now looking at what I would describe as AI-enabled procurement platforms. All the vendors that you listed, I would add ServiceNow, Workday, some of the ERP providers like SAP and Microsoft as well as we look to enhance our capabilities and how we go to market.

Client 00:00:53

Thank you. What spend categories go mostly through these tools? What's maybe the split or the rough percentage of indirect versus direct spend in your company?

Expert 00:01:06

Got it. Happy to give an overview. Indirect procurement I would say is over 80% or so. Direct is probably under 20%. We're not a manufacturer, so we don't really buy raw materials, so direct spend's primary. Roughly, for Zip, that's our primary intake and orchestration layer. That's probably the majority of that, so maybe over $4 billion annually. Omnea, that's more strategic procurement, like supplier life cycle. That's much lower, so that's under $3 billion.

Client 00:01:44

Perfect. Maybe the final question, just to set the context, what's the current stack? You mentioned you use ***Zip***, you use ***Omnea***. Is there something below that you're using as well in terms of ***procurement*** tools?

Expert 00:01:59

Yeah. If we're just talking about our procurement stack, I would say we do use parts of our ERP and our financial systems and IT workflows. You could think of ServiceNow, Workday Financials or Workday HCM. E-signature on that would be Docusign. We use other spend analytics across Snowflake and Power BI, but I would say Zip and Omnea. We did look at Lio as more of an assistant or a knowledge base, but we're not ready for that right now. That's basically the layers and some platforms that link to those layers for you.

Client 00:02:34

Okay. Zip would sit on top of your ERP basically, along with Omnea? The source of truth stays in your ERP in terms of data

Expert 00:02:43

That is the system of record of course. Yes.

Client 00:02:49

Perfect. If we jump to how the evaluation started and how you decided to work with Zip and then Omnea. Could you just talk us through that decision? We can go into more detail into specific criteria that made you choose Zip and then Omnea.

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Expert 00:03:06

Let's start with why were we looking at all? We weren't trying to replace our system of record. **Our problem statement** was more around colleagues didn't really like the procurement process. Cycle times were too long. Supplier onboarding in a very regulated vertical for us was very tedious. I think AI was just becoming a board-level priority for us. It was more of an objective I would describe around building a more modern AI-enabled procurement, like what I would describe as an operating layer, rather than ripping and replacing our ERP or our systems of record.

We started with a steering committee. We defined functional requirements, especially around the employee experience, and how we would manage suppliers and our procurement operations. How we were looking at AI in terms of search capabilities, any procurement co-pilots, any supplier recommendations, intake automation. We started looking at integration. That was critical. Could it integrate with our systems of record? We did a market scan and partnership with our third-party integrators, so you could think of them as like an Accenture, an EXL, and a Deloitte. We went through and we assessed and ran through a POC or a proof of concept. We did you could say like a scorecard for each.

Client 00:04:35

Super clear. How many companies did you have to start with in your evaluation beyond Zip and Omnea?

Expert 00:04:42

I would say in total, we probably scanned maybe around 12-14 different ones. That would be SAP Ariba, Coupa, Workday, and the vendors that you listed.

Client 00:04:54

Who were the finalists next to Zip, the ones that you pushed further in the process?

Expert 00:05:00

I'm thinking we did an initial scan then we did a capability assessment. Are you saying who made it to the proof of concept or who made it to the final selection?

Client 00:05:11

Exactly. Who you liked most and you brought to the more final stages of your evaluation process is what I mean.

Expert 00:05:20

Thank you very much. I think of it as almost like a sales funnel. Outside of Zip, Omnea, ServiceNow was a finalist, Workday was a finalist, and I would say Coupa, SAP were more semi-finalists, and askLio as well, was a semi-finalist.

Client 00:05:40

One quick question to jump in, because it sounds like you didn't use Coupa beforehand? Before then, ***Zip*** and ***Omnea*** came in. Basically, all the ***procurement*** before that was just run on your ERP system. Is that correct?

Expert 00:05:55

Correct.

Client 00:05:56

Just out of curiosity, ServiceNow and Workday, you were also evaluating them for specifically procurement and intake for the system because they have modules that focus on those?

Expert 00:06:08

Yes, but they're not built from the ground up for that. They have offerings for it, but they are nowhere as comprehensive as a purpose-built vendor.

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Client 00:06:18

Perfect. If we go back to the criteria you mentioned, employee experience, AI features, and then integration and so on, could you explain what you liked and disliked about the companies you mentioned, more specifically Zip, the criteria why you chose it, but also versus Coupa, and then versus Omnea on the criteria. Giving us more color around the scorecard that you mentioned.

Expert 00:06:43

Yeah. I think what you're asking is I'll do that around the finalists?

Client 00:06:49

Exactly.

Expert 00:06:50

Okay. I would say thinking about that criteria, probably one of the bigger one that I put a spotlight on was the colleague experience. Thinking about employee intake and just the UI/UX. Zip was probably a 10/10 in that area, 10 being the best. Omnea was probably 9/10 there. ServiceNow was probably an eight. Workday was a seven. On the workflow orchestration, Zip was probably nearly a 10 there. Omnea was a nine. ServiceNow would probably be a nine as well. Workday, I'd probably put at a seven and a half.

AI capabilities, Zip, again, was about a 10 there. Omnea, I'd put as a nine. ServiceNow, I'd put at probably eight and a half. Workday I'd put at a seven. ERP integration depth, again, I'd put Zip at probably nine and a half, Omnea at a nine. ServiceNow I'd put them at a 10 and Workday at a 10. No surprising there. They're more mature, so their catalog is going to be deeper.

Life cycle for the supplier, that's probably Zip's a nine. Omnea would be a 10 there. ServiceNow I'd put them as an eight. Workday I'd put as an eight. Time to actually integrate and launch. Zip is probably the quickest by far. Them I'd put as a 10. Omnea I'd put next as a nine. ServiceNow and Workday I'd both put at seven and a half. Just overall user adoption and experience, I'd put Zip at a 10, Omnea at a nine, ServiceNow and Workday both at a seven and a half.

Client 00:08:41

Okay. I understand Zip is basically almost nine or 9.5 or 10/10, which probably is the reason why you ended up choosing it.

Expert 00:08:51

Yeah.

Client 00:08:53

If we could then double-click on Zip and Omnea, which score very closely on most of your criteria, could you give us a bit more color and detail around the differences, ultimately, for example, when it comes to UI/UX, what was the difference between Zip and Omnea? What made **it a little less good** ultimately?

Expert 00:09:12

Just compared to those two. I would say both scored really high. The approach on how each of them attack procurement, they went from opposite directions. ***Zip*** started with the colleague experience and built ***procurement*** around that experience. ***Omnea*** started with more of procurement operations and then extended that experience to the colleague. Our objective was obviously enterprise-wide adoption, we wanted people using it, and standardization of the intake process across our colleague base. I think **Zip, in that framework, had the stronger value proposition** because, in our view, they start with the employee experience. Omnea started with more of just the excellence around the procurement process.

I think something to put on the spotlight there is just the intake experience, in my view, was the largest differentiator. An employee opens Zip, as example, and they say, "I need a marketing agency to work on a merchant campaign with." Their AI determines the software, the services, the legal review, the whole process. There's no procurement knowledge required. It almost works like an OpenAI, very consumer-grade. Omnea, very good, but the feedback was people still thought they were entering a procurement process, which just had more structure, more procurement terminology that the average colleague wasn't really as comfortable with. Still excellent, but not quite invisible there.

Client 00:10:44

Okay. How many people would use Omnea in the company, and Zip? Both of them.

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Expert 00:10:51

Got it. I would say out of procurement with vendor management, strategic sourcing, you'd probably have maybe 600-800 power users, and then you'd have a few thousand of occasional approvers and reviewers.

Client 00:11:04

To ask on that part, because it sounds like Zip is clearly the better solution across the board. How come the desire to use both in parallel, both Omnea and Zip?

Expert 00:11:16

Thanks for that. Zip is our primary. I would say we bought an enterprise intake platform and a ***procurement*** ops platform. Zip's optimized for the colleague experience and the orchestration across our enterprise. ***Omnea*** is more optimized for the supplier life cycle management and execution of the procurement. They address different parts of what I would describe as the value chain. We have a lot more spend on Zip than we do on Omnea, if I just think about our annual spend with these vendors.

Client 00:11:50

Do you think eventually you could imagine moving everything to Zip as they maybe expand and improve their product or do you prefer to not go with only one vendor and do a best-of-breed approach where you still keep different ones depending on their capabilities?

Expert 00:12:05

Yeah. I also see a future, and we're not ready for it, but where we use askLio. Very impressed with them. We weren't ready for that AI layer that they had, but I see instituting them. I would say if we're just talking about these two, I think most likely we would probably expand with Zip, but we would continue using both. I would say maybe what could be possible, maybe 20% likelihood, where we expand Zip to the point where we replace Omnea. That's only if they deepen capabilities around onboarding and vendor risk.

Client 00:12:43

Understood. If we go back to AI, you mentioned Zip was better on these two compared to Omnea. Could you double-click here and what exactly Zip has that Omnea doesn't have and vice versa?

Expert 00:12:57

Yeah. Just between those two, if we're talking on AI, I wouldn't put it in the context of who has the better LLM model. I would say it's more about who uses AI to create value. I would say Zip puts AI at the very start. Example would be like a marketing director comes in and says like, "I need an agency to launch a campaign," and that campaign might be in Europe. The AI there immediately understands we're talking professional services, legal review, security review, is it needed? The employee never needs to know that. That AI orchestrates that whole process. Same thing with an engineering example or if a VP asks for something. The AI acts like what I would call your procurement concierge. Omnea's AI is AI inside the procurement process.

Theirs becomes valuable after procurement owns the request. They're, I would say, not a concierge, they're more like a manager. If you're thinking about which contracts renew next quarter, which suppliers might have expired insurance with us. There's different AI personas. Zip AI, I would say the user is every employee. That's why it's much more expansive. Omnea's the user is more direct procurement. It's like I already have a specific request. Their AI helps determine which supplier, which contract, risk, and compliance. Every colleague for Zip, that more talks about existing vendors, approval, the who, what, why, where, and how there. That's how I would think about it. Zip is more of like AI agent, autonomous buying, budget reasoning. Omnea is more about overall supplier intel, contract AI, procurement copilots. It's just a different experience.

Client 00:15:01

Understood. Do you use the supplier intelligence module as well for Omnea?

Expert 00:15:08

Yes. I would say if you go back to your previous question where you compare them, that's where Omnea, in my opinion, is hands down stronger than Zip.

Client 00:15:19

Okay. Could you maybe make an example how you use it concretely?

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Expert 00:15:25
I would say let's go back to the colleague experience around marketing agency. A marketing VP submits a request around a global agency need to support a new merchant acquisition campaign. Omnea would take over after Zip handles the front end of that request, like understanding the request, the examples we went through earlier. Omnea, rather than the procurement process manually researching those agencies, the supplier intel surfaces.

We already have relationships with Accenture, Deloitte, or WPP. They look at, with those vendors, is their cybersecurity assessment expiring? Are all pieces up to date? They might look at is Accenture with the negotiated volume discount threshold, are we already there? That category manager, if you will, can immediately narrow the funnel and then pick the most appropriate suppliers that we would want to work with without rebuilding the process for that colleague.

Client 00:16:27
Understood. The data sources that flow into this assessment, is it something that Omnea provided to you from scratch or did you also integrate some existing data sources, say, on specific risks that you assess or others?

Expert 00:16:41
Great question on the data flow. I would say, if you think about that, the data type, that would be ERP spend from the ERP. In that previous example, you're looking at historical spend and invoices to see if we hit the volume thresholds. The contracts, they could even be at a SharePoint or else like Ironclad. That's where you get the contract terms and the pricing. I would say the ERP, or from a security perspective, on that previous example, that could be from ServiceNow. It mostly comes from that. I would say on the financial health of a supplier, if you're talking credit risk, that feeds in from relationships that we have from like Dun & Bradstreet or Standard & Poor's. It feeds in from different sources.

Client 00:17:31
Okay. Standard & Poor's, for example, you would have an API access, and you can pull data directly to Omnea and have the comprehensive view there, if I understand it correctly?

Expert 00:17:44
Correct. That's exactly it. It's an API feed.

Client 00:17:51
Maybe you also mentioned Lio once or twice briefly as an up-and-coming player that you were thinking of integrating with more in the future. Would love to get your thoughts on what exactly makes **Lio strong** here, compared to Zip or compared to Omnea.

Expert 00:18:06
Great question. I would say Lio is fundamentally different from both. I would say it's not trying to be a procurement workflow platform. I would say it's trying to be more of the end-to-end enterprise intelligence layer that sits across all other systems. The capability **I think compared to Zip and Omnea on the intake process, Zip and Omnea rate really strong** there. Workflow orchestration is strong. I would say approvals, supplier repository, and **those examples are strong**. That's where Lio lacks. **Lio, on the other side, is extremely strong** if you're looking at an AI assistant, if you're thinking about cross-system AI reasoning, if you're thinking about more of a knowledge search across the enterprise, and I would say supplier intelligence last. They really lead on those three.

To me, their differentiator, which we're not ready for right now, is cross-system reasoning. It's not like how do I buy something? It's tell me everything we know about this vendor, and that vendor might be Microsoft. Lio would search across your stack and provide a single answer like should we renew Microsoft? ***Zip*** can't really provide something. ***Omnea*** could give you something from a pure ***procurement*** perspective. I would say Lio, in that lineup, goes much further. The answer that they give spans multiple systems and it would have a much richer context around like your Azure consumption rate, your current contracts expiring and when they're expiring. Things like that. Happy to go into another example, but that's how I would talk about the three with an example.

Client 00:19:55
Got it. It sounds more as if Lio will be a complement to the other two solutions rather than replacing one of them.

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Expert 00:20:02

Absolutely. I would say as **we continue to grow with Zip, Lio** could be a layer that we would be interested in adding on top of that as the enterprise AI layer that sits on top of these two systems. I think as we expand more with Lio, it would more likely run on that.

Client 00:20:22

Got it. Maybe just a final question from my side. You mentioned time to integrate and launch was also very important to you. What was the time there from, say, signing the contract to live for Zip and for Omnea?

Expert 00:20:37

Is it going live for a pilot or going live for a more of an expanded rollout?

Client 00:20:42

Both.

Expert 00:20:43

Let me do time to signing to time to pilot, and then time to signing because we had phases more of full expand. I would say the selection piece to contract was probably like seven to nine weeks. The implementation was about eight to 12 weeks for Zip and about maybe 11-15 weeks for Omnea. A little bit longer for Omnea there. Pilot to go live each took around three to four months. Enterprise rollout took, for Zip, maybe about 10-12 months, so like a year, slightly under one year. Omnea took I would say a little over one year to one year and a half. A little bit longer for Omnea to deploy.

Client 00:21:29

Understood. I think everything is clear. Thank you very much and have a good rest of your day.

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